

GOOGLE ADS • AI MAX SEARCH-TERM AUDIT • EXECUTIVE BRIEF

AI Max is buying competitors' names, not new patients.

OVERALL VERDICT

Keep AI Max enabled — under tight controls.
Restrict it hard on Ortho Excellence and Holt.

Why not disable

The highly relevant slice of AI Max converted at \$110 — better than the \$138 keyword benchmark. The mechanism works; it is the unrestrained 59% that destroys the average.

Why not leave it

AI Max takes 40% of search spend to return 32% of conversions, at a 40% worse cost per lead.

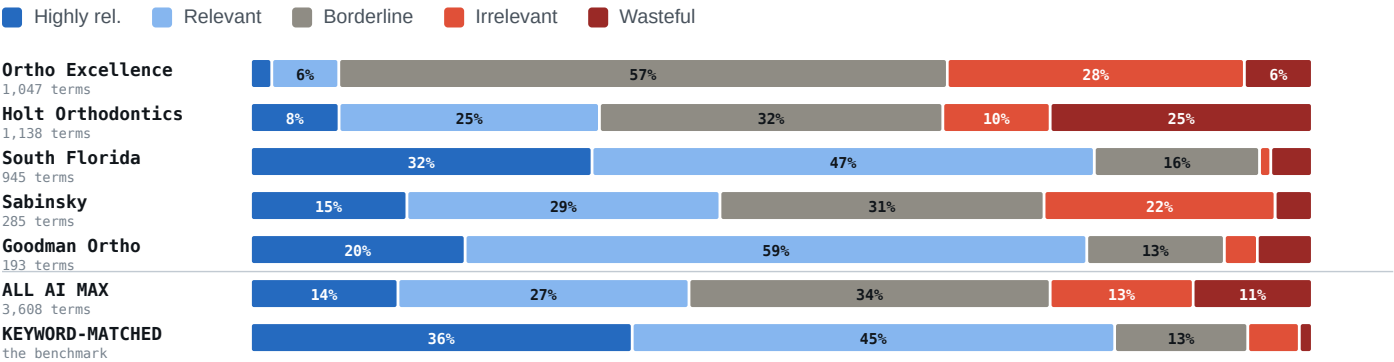
Confidence

High on relevance & waste (3,608 classified terms, reproduces in all five accounts, independent of conversion counts). **Medium** on efficiency (17.64 conversions, 30 days). **Low** on Goodman & Sabinsky individually (13 and 10 clicks).

AI MAX SHARE OF SPEND	SHARE OF CONVERSIONS	COST PER CONVERSION	TERMS THAT ARE RELEVANT	SPEND ON BAD TERMS
40%	32%	\$193	41%	\$920
\$3,409 of \$8,615	17.64 of 55.26 — buys more than it returns	vs \$138 keyword — 40% worse	vs 81% on keyword traffic	27.0% of AI Max spend vs 1.8%

What AI Max actually bought

82.2% of AI Max spend went to queries naming a specific practice, provider, or street address — against 28.5% of keyword-matched spend. 249 terms were bare street addresses with no service word at all, costing \$338. Its vocabulary skews to “dental” (957 uses) and “dentist” (388) over all orthodontic terms combined (574): on-service for one general dental practice, off-service for four orthodontists.



Share of AI Max search terms by patient intent, per account. Bottom two rows are the control: all AI Max traffic, then the same classifier applied to keyword-matched traffic in the same accounts. Keyword traffic is 81.4% relevant and 6.1% off-target; AI Max is 41.3% relevant and 24.7% off-target — a four-fold increase. Ortho Excellence is the extreme: 8.3% relevant.

Verdict by account

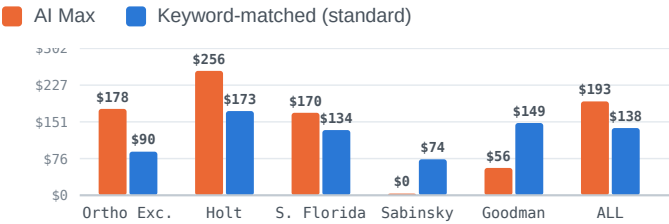
Restrict hard	Ortho Excellence	73.5% of account spend at 8.3% relevance; 6 of 7 conversions were general-dental, not ortho.
Restrict	Holt Orthodontics	Largest absolute waste: \$500 off-target, incl. \$297 on 205 bare street addresses. CPA 48% worse.
Keep + monitor	South Florida	Only account where AI Max lands on-service — it is a general dental practice. 27% already negated.
Restrict / monitor	Sabinsky	Zero conversions on \$96 / 10 clicks. A red flag, but too few clicks to call it a failure.
Monitor	Goodman Ortho	Cleanest profile and the only CPA win — but \$112 and 13 clicks. Not actionable either way.

AI Max vs. keyword-matched traffic

Same accounts, same window, same conversion tracking. The only variable is whether Google matched the query to a keyword or generated it through AI Max.

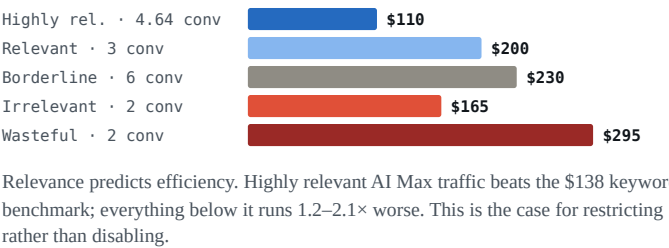
METRIC	AI MAX	KEYWORD-MATCHED	READ
Search terms	3,608	3,319	AI Max adds 9% more terms
Clicks	267	393	40% of clicks
CTR	4.04%	4.85%	-17% – weaker query-to-ad match
Avg. CPC	\$12.77	\$13.25	-4% – clicks are cheaper
Cost	\$3,409	\$5,206	40% of search spend
Conversions	17.64	37.62	32% of conversions
Conversion rate	6.61%	9.57%	-31% – cheap clicks that don’t convert
Cost per conversion	\$193	\$138	+40% worse per lead
Relevant terms	41.3%	81.4%	-40.1 points
Irrelevant + wasteful terms	24.7%	6.1%	4.0× more off-target
Spend on irrelevant terms	\$920 (27.0%)	\$94.36 (1.8%)	15× more waste
Named-entity spend	82.2%	28.5%	competitors & addresses
Spend with zero conversions	89.0%	68.7%	\$3,035 returned nothing

COST PER CONVERSION, BY ACCOUNT



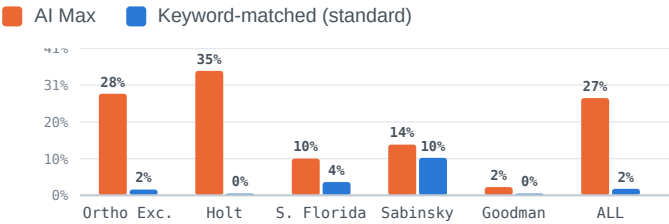
AI Max costs more per lead in four of five accounts. Sabinsky has no bar — it produced no conversions at all.

AI MAX COST PER CONVERSION, BY INTENT CLASS



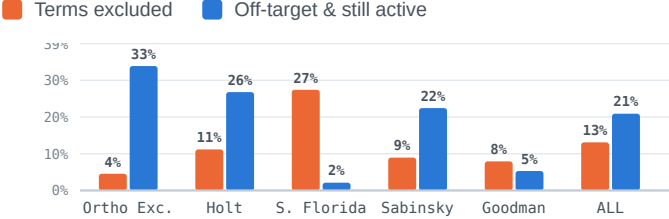
Relevance predicts efficiency. Highly relevant AI Max traffic beats the \$138 keyword benchmark; everything below it runs 1.2–2.1× worse. This is the case for restricting rather than disabling.

SHARE OF SPEND ON OFF-TARGET TERMS



The cleanest separation in the dataset, and it does not depend on conversion counts. Keyword traffic stays near zero everywhere.

EXCLUSION COVERAGE VS. UNGUARDED WASTE



Only 467 of 3,608 AI Max terms (12.9%) are negated. 744 off-target terms still carry no negative and have spent \$406. Exclusion is retrospective — it recovers nothing already spent.

The conversions AI Max did produce are not all real leads

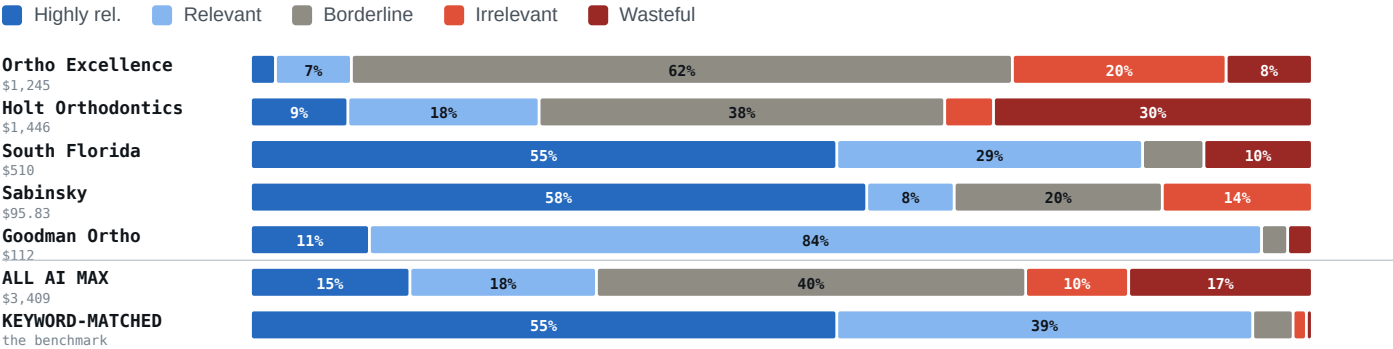
Of 17.64 AI Max conversions, only 4.64 came from highly relevant searches. The rest include a hospital lookup (sutter health hospital sacramento, \$23.61), a bare address (140 roseville pkwy suite 150..., \$28.20) and, at Ortho Excellence, six conversions from general-dental searches (dentist tacoma, dental clinic near me) on an account that sells orthodontics. **Incrementality:** six of the 17 converting terms contained no word the account already reached through keywords — the rest is duplicated intent, and the “new” vocabulary is almost entirely competitors’ proper nouns. AI Max found new *names*, not new *demand*.

Account-by-account

Relevance is judged per account, against the services each practice actually advertises — “emergency dentist” is highly relevant for South Florida and irrelevant for Sabinsky.

ACCOUNT	RELEVANT	IRRELEVANT	EXCLUDED	AI MAX SPEND	CONV.	AI MAX CPA	KEYWORD CPA	VERDICT
Ortho Excellence	8.3%	34.4%	4.5%	\$1,245	7	\$178	\$90	● Restrict hard
Holt Orthodontics	32.9%	34.8%	11.0%	\$1,446	5.64	\$256	\$173	● Restrict
South Florida	79.5%	5.0%	27.0%	\$510	3	\$170	\$134	● Keep + monitor
Sabinsky	44.2%	25.3%	8.8%	\$95.83	0	–	\$74	● Restrict / monitor
Goodman Ortho	78.8%	8.3%	7.8%	\$112	2	\$56	\$149	● Monitor
All five accounts	41.3%	24.7%	12.9%	\$3,409	17.64	\$193	\$138	Restrict

Where the AI Max money went



Page 1’s picture weighted by money rather than term count — the chart that matters. 27.0% of AI Max spend (\$920) bought irrelevant or wasteful clicks, against 1.8% (\$94.36) on keyword traffic. Only \$512 — 15% — went to unambiguously on-target searches.

Do this next

- **Ortho Excellence — restrict hard, this week.** 73.5% of search spend at 8.3% relevance. Turn AI Max off in the Puyallup/Bonney Lake campaign, or add brand exclusions plus a general-dentistry negative list before the next billing cycle.
- **Holt — add an address/numeric negative pattern now.** 205 address terms cost \$297 for one questionable conversion. Then negate non-dental specialties: veneers, endodontics, wisdom teeth, optometry.
- **Deploy one shared negative list** across all four ortho accounts — general dentistry, other dental specialties, non-dental medical, DTC aligner brands, address patterns. It addresses most of the \$920 waste.
- **Turn on brand exclusions** — 82.2% of AI Max spend is competitor and address traffic.
- **Fix conversion tracking** before the next review: no values or action names means nobody can tell a booked consult from a form start.
- **Re-measure in 60–90 days.** Do not disable Goodman or Sabinsky on 10–13 clicks.

Three limits on this data

1 • Google withholds 29-45% of the spend

Named terms cover only 55–71% of each account’s search spend; the rest sits in the privacy-thresholded “Other search terms” bucket, attributable to neither AI Max nor keywords. Holt is weakest — 45% of its conversions are invisible.

2 • No conversion values or action names

One blended Conversions column, so booked consults cannot be separated from form starts. Treat every conversion here as a lead signal of unknown quality.

3 • One 30-day window, 267 AI Max clicks

Ample for relevance conclusions, thin for efficiency ones. Goodman (\$112) and Sabinsky (\$96) are too small to judge on performance at all.